Social institutions

Social Institutions are the organized system that make society function.They are not buildings or offices but sets of rules, roles and relationships that help people live together peacefully.These institutions structure our lives by guiding how we behave, interact and meet basic needs.

Every Community no matter how large or Small, depends on them to maintain order and stability.

From birth to death we are shaped bySocial institutions

SOCIAL INSTITUTIONS

Social institutions have been created by man from social relationships in society to meet such basic needs as stability, law and order and clearly defined roles of authority and decision making. Every organization is dependent upon a certain recognized and established set of rules, traditions and usages. These usages and rules may be given the name of institutions. These are the forms of procedure which are recognised and accepted by society and govern the relations between individuals and groups.

They influence what we learn, how we work, how we form families and even what we believe.

Without them life would be chaotic because people would not know how to behave or What roles to play in Society
A social institution is an interrelated system of social roles and social norms, organized around the satisfaction of an important social need or social function.

DEFINITIONS

ACCORDING TO WOOD WARD AND MAXWELL:
An institution is a set of folkways and mores into a unit which serves a number of social functions.

ACCORDING TO HORTON:
An institution is an organized system of social relationships which embodies certain common values and procedures and meets certain basic needs of society.

CHARACTERISTICS:

Institutions are the means of controlling individuals.

Institutions depend upon the collective activities of men.

The institution has some definite procedures which are formed on the basis of customs and dogmas.

Institution is more stable than other means of social control.

Every institution has some rules which must be compulsorily obeyed by the individual

Characteristics of social institution

Social institutions are universal.

They vary from time to time and across cultures, in terms of complexity, specialization, scope, formality and organization. But their basic nature and purpose are similar everywhere.

Social institutions are resistant to change; they tend to persist.

Each institution performs two types of social function.

(a) primary functions, which are also called manifest, explicit, or direct functions;

(b) secondary functions, which are also called indirect, hidden, or latent functions. Through these functions, social institutions fulfill important needs in the society

Various social institutions are

1. Marriage

2. Family

3. Education

4. Economy

5. Religion

6. Political institution

FAMILY

Family is the smallest social unit. The family is the most important primary group in the society. It consists of two or more people who live together.

Difference between family and household

A household is made up of one or more people who live in the same dwelling unit. But the members of the household need not necessarily be related to each other.

In a family, the members are related by marriage, blood or adoption.

A family is always a household but every household is not necessarily a family.

Talcott Parsons' Warm Bath theory

Parsons' Warm Bath theory suggests that when a man comes home from a busy day of work, his family provides him with stress relief and relaxation; just as a warm bath would. This ensures the emotional needs of the breadwinner are met.

According to Talcott Parsons family has two important functions:

1. Primary socialization of children

2. Stabilization of adult personality

In Agrarian society family is a unit of production/economic unit.

In Industrial society family is a unit of consumption.

Functions of the family

The family, as a social institution, performs several functions. Various scholars have categorized the functions of family.

According to G. P. Murdock, the family has four essential functions:

1. Sexual function: Regulates sexual activity and provides sexual gratification for both men and women

2. Reproductive function: Only the nuclear family can effectively reproduce

3. Educational function: Socializes children into the norms and values of society

4. Economic function: Provides food and security for children and economic cooperation

MacIver classifies the functions of family into two categories

1. Essential functions

2. Non-essential functions.

According to him, the essential functions include

(i) The stable satisfaction of sex needs

(ii) Production and rearing of children

(iii) Provision of home

Under the non-essential functions, he listed out

(i) Religious

(ii) Educational

(iii) Economic

(iv) Health

(v) Recreation

Ogburn and Nimkoff have mentioned six major functions of family as follows

1. Affectional

2. Economic

3. Recreational

4. Protective

5. Religious

6. Educational

Classification of Family

On the basis of size and of structure of the family and the relationship of the members with each other, the family is classified as

1.Joint Family: This family consists of more than two generations. In traditional societies and most parts of India this type of family exist.

2. Nuclear family: The nuclear family consists of parents and their biological or adopted unmarried children.

3. Extended family: The extended family consists of parents, children and some other members who are related by blood or marriage. Other members usually include a parent, one of the siblings and his/her family.

There are 15 types of families which are Created based on 5 bases

Based On Size/Structure

1) Joint Family or Extended Family

2) Nuclear/Modern Family

<u>Based On Authority</u>

1) Patriarchal Family System

2) Matriarchal Family System

Based On Residence:

1) Patrilocal

Matrilocal

<u>Based On Marriage:</u>

1) Monogamy

2) Polygamy

3) Polyandry

<u>Based On Ancestry:</u>

1) Patrilineal

2) Matrilineal

<u>Based On In-Group And Out-Group:</u>

1) Endogamous

2) Exogamous

<u>Based On Blood Relationships:</u>

1) Conjugal Family

2) Consanguineous Family

<u>Joint family</u>

Joint family - When people of two or more generations live together, it is called a joint family.

Two nuclear families come together to form a joint family.

A joint family is also called an extended family.

Nuclear Family

This family consists of a husband, wife, and their children, with or without children

Authority- two types of family structures

a .Patriarchal family system

b:matriarchal family system

Patriarchal family

In this type of family system, the head of the household is the man and all decisions are made by men.

Women have a secondary position in this type of family.

Such methods are found all over the world, and the family in India is patriarchal. notes

matriarchal family system

This type of family system is the exact opposite of a patriarchal family system.

The main person in the house is the woman, and all decisions are taken by women as the head of the family.

This practice is found in some primitive tribes in North India.

Based on residence two types of family

a .Patrilocal
b.Matrilocal

Patrilocal family:
In this type, the wife goes to the husband's house to live permanently after marriage.

Matrilocal Family:
In this type, the husband goes to the wife's house to live permanently after marriage.

Based on marriage- Three types:

1) Monogamy,

2) Polygamy, and

3) Polyandry

Monogamy family

Monogamy: In this type, one man marries one woman.

Polygamy: In this type, one man marries two or more women.

Polyandry: In this type, one woman marries two or more men.

Based on ancestry- Two types
a .patrilineal
b .matrilineal families

Patrilineal Family

In this type, the lineage is continued through the father, and genealogy is formed through the father.
Ancestry continues through the father.

Matrilineal families
In this type, the lineage continues through the mother.
Ancestry continues through the mother

in-group and out-group,
Endogamous and Exogamous families.

Endogamous families.
This type of group allows marriage only between members of a group or within a caste.
Sanctions marriage only among members of the in-group.

Exogamous families.
This type of group allows the marriage of in-group members with out-group members.
Sanctions marriage of members of an in-group with members of an out-group.

Based on blood relationships,
a .conjugal families and
b .consanguineous families

Conjugal families

This type of family includes a husband and wife, their offspring, and those who become relatives through marriage.

Consists of spouses, their offspring, and relatives through marriage.

consanguineous families

In this type of family, relatives are connected by blood relation, including blood with spouse and children.

Impact of Family on Society

Social Cohesion: Strong family bonds
contribute to social cohesion, promoting trust and cooperation within communities.
Sociologists play a crucial role in studying families, analyzing their impact on individuals and society, and identifying factors that influence family dynamics and structures.